

what you'd pay elsewhere. Find out about your employer's offerings and also price several term policies on your own.

↓ **INSURANCE YOU PROBABLY DON'T NEED**

It's very tempting to buy quickie insurance on impulse. After all, it seems so cheap—just \$10 a day to get collision coverage at the rental car counter, or \$25 for \$50,000 worth of life insurance at the airport. But before you throw money at this kind of coverage, evaluate it carefully. In most cases, you don't need it.

- **Rental car collision protection.** If you've ever rented a car, you were probably asked if you wanted to buy the **loss damage waiver**, which is just a fancy name for collision insurance. Next time, do a little research in advance. Review your credit card agreements to see if you're automatically protected when you charge a car rental on the card. And if you already have collision and comprehensive insurance on your own car, find out if your policy extends to rented cars. (See chapter 8 for more on the ins and outs of insuring rental cars.)
- **Flight accident insurance.** If you need to insure your life, the cheapest way to do it when you're young is to buy a term life insurance policy. Don't waste money buying life insurance at a vending machine in the airport. Sure it's tempting (this type of insurance plays on our fear of flying) and it also seems cheap, but it doesn't make sense. Your chances of slipping and killing yourself on the ground are much greater than your chances of dying in a plane crash. Besides, you may already be covered if you have life insurance, for example. Many credit card companies give you automatic flight insurance if you charge your tickets on their card, so be sure to check.